

RACE AGAINST TIME

Soon after *Titanic* hit the iceberg, it was clear that the ship was doomed. The challenge now was to keep the engines running and the lights on for long enough to get as many people as possible into lifeboats. A team of firemen and engineers battled to keep the ship going as, one by one, the boiler rooms filled with water.



Feeding the fires

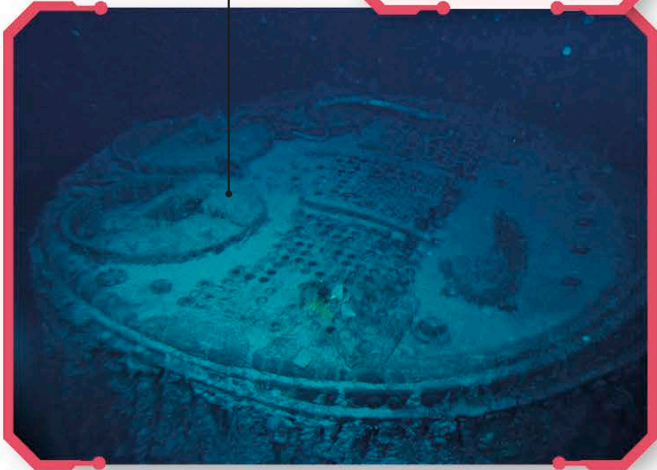
The *Titanic* was powered by burning coal, which produced steam that drove the engines. The “black gang” of 289 firemen constantly shoveled coal into the 29 massive boilers to keep the engines running at full speed.

Each boiler room had a team of 14 men, feeding every boiler a ton of coal every two minutes.

First find

In 1985, as the *Titanic* discovery expedition, having failed to find the wreck, neared the end of its mission, a huge object appeared on the video feed from the ocean floor: one of the ship’s boilers. After 73 years, *Titanic* had finally been found.

The boiler sat face-up, the circular furnace doors clearly visible.



1 *Titanic* had 29 of these colossal boilers, spread out over six boiler rooms.

2 The boilers have three coal-fired furnaces at each end.